



Individual Teaching Assistant Report Fall 2024 for ECO 353M - EMPIRICAL PUBLIC ECONOMICS (34020) (Ziheng Yu)

Project Title: **Course Evaluations Fall 2024**

Courses Audience: **59**

Responses Received: **15**

Response Ratio: **25.4%**

Report Comments

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. The two sets of scales used for core evaluation questions and the associated weights are:

Strongly Agree (5)

Agree (4)

Neutral (3)

Disagree (2)

Strongly Disagree (1)

Excellent (5)

Very Good (4)

Satisfactory (3)

Unsatisfactory (2)

Very Unsatisfactory (1)

The Mean is calculated by adding all of the weights for a single question and dividing by the number of respondents. The course workload question is not averaged.

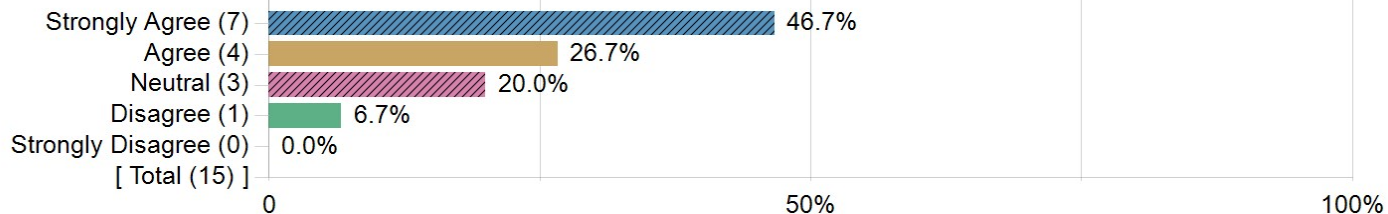
The number of students (e.g. respondents) marking each option is reported for each of the items. These frequency distributions provide information about the level of student ratings and the spread and shape of the class distribution of responses. The distributions thus provide a picture of student perception of a course.

Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness; multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor.

Creation Date: **Friday, January 24, 2025**

Teaching Assistant Questions

The TA was available to help me as needed.



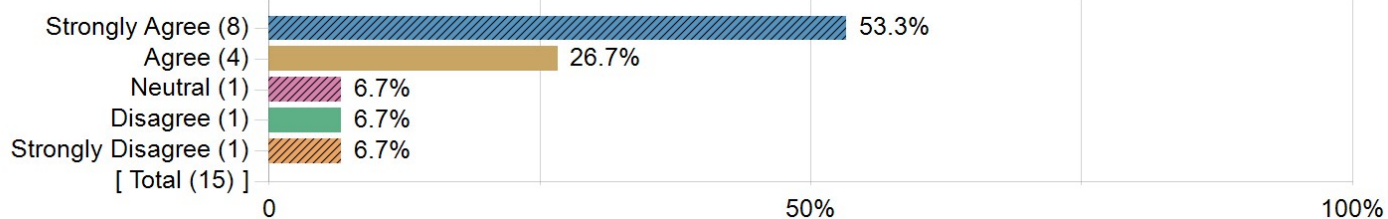
Statistics

Value

Mean

4.13

I felt the TA was approachable.



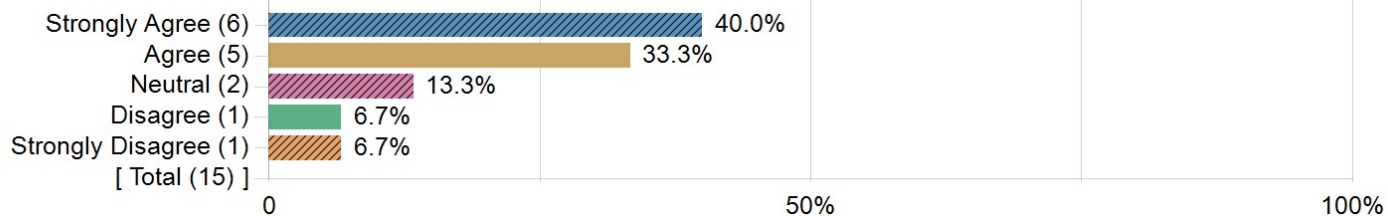
Statistics

Value

Mean

4.13

The TA explained course concepts, subject matter, or other course-related topics in a way that helped me learn.



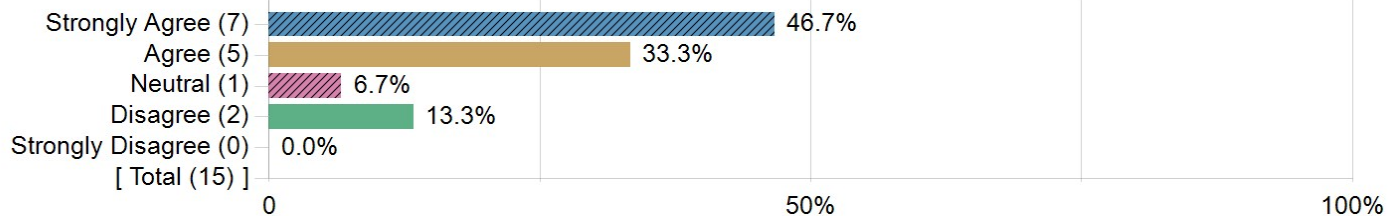
Statistics

Value

Mean

3.93

The TA was able to address most of my questions related to the course concepts, subject -matter, or topics.



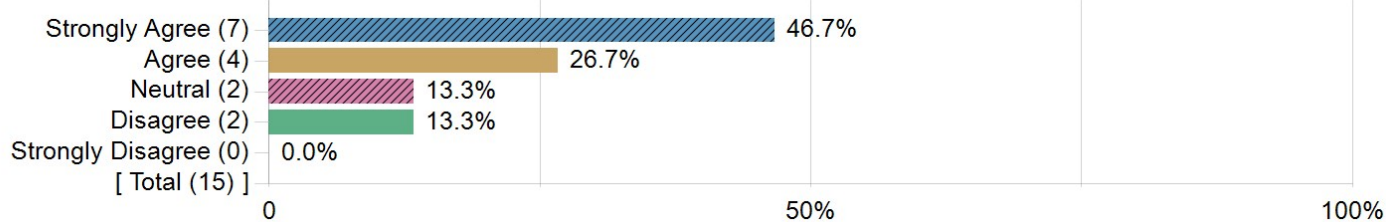
Statistics

Value

Mean

4.13

The TA communicated course content and subject matter with accuracy.



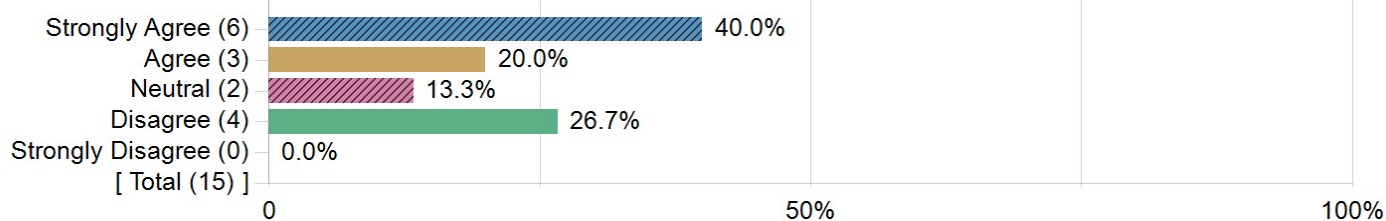
Statistics

Value

Mean

4.07

The TA communicated course expectations and instructions clearly.



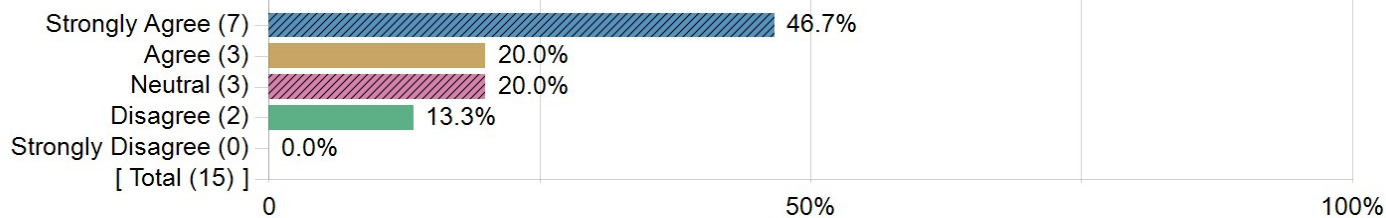
Statistics

Value

Mean

3.73

The TA appeared engaged throughout the course experience.



Statistics

Value

Mean

4.00

Comment Questions

Identify aspects of your interactions with your teaching assistant that were most effective in helping your learning.

Comments

n/a

All

Fast response time to my questions

Helping with clarifying hw questions.

He responded to my emails and gave me practical ways to solve the problems that I had.

Ziheng Yu was very responsive when I contacted him through email. This was very helpful as at times I felt very lost in the course.

TA Ziheng Yu was helpful during office hours.

Always reachable online

Timely grading.

What is one thing the teaching assistant could do differently to help improve future students' learning in this course?

Comments
n/a
None
None
N/A
There needs to be more communication between the TA and the professor. The TA consistently said he did not know what the professor expected which is an issue on both ends.
Be less strict. It's not very helpful if students go to office hours and ask a question about the homework and get told you can't because I'd give you the answer
Clearer expectations of how in depth answers to homework and exam questions should be
N/A
More feedback on exams would be helpful.